

Title: Early game midlane wave management in a melee vs ranged matchup

Score:

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Hello, my question is specifically about early game, levels 1-3. Let's say I'm playing midlane against a mage as a melee champion with no early ranged abilities.

First wave I can probably take the melee creeps. If I do nothing with the backline, the second wave arrives I probably lose one ranged and one melee at least- but they gain the push for sure. Now:

- * should I let it crash?
- * should I try to hold it in front of the tower and crash on the third wave?
- * should I have traded HP for those minions if I don't expect them to have kill pressure?

I know some of those are probably champion- and matchup specific but I'd like to have a general idea, considering that- as far as I understand- as a midlaner I probably want to have an early impact.

--- TOP COMMENTS ---

[Comment 1 | Score: 5]

The general rule is health > cs early on. You're gonna lose the pushing race pretty much by default so you basically just let them dictate when they crash. Do not hold the wave if you're going to take a lot of damage. Just let them do their thing and take as little damage as you can while getting as much farm as you can.

[Comment 2 | Score: 5]

Extremely matchup dependent. What you want to do with the first three waves changes against

every champ. That said, getting pushed in and playing out the bounce on level 3 is the vast majority of melee vs ranged matchups (see legendary moment where Dopa is playing TF vs Fizz, Fizz hits the wave once and Dopa responds with "He just lost the game").

[Comment 3 | Score: 2]

Let the wave come in to you and conserve hp. Wave crashes into your tower on wave 2, and will bounce out on wave 3. You will hit level 3 before them on wave 3 because their minions will die first because the wave is closer to your tower, so your minions will be focus firing the enemy melees.

This window where you are level 3 to their level 2 is where you want to push the advantage and all in them if you can. If they back off and avoid your all in attempt, you should be able to play the lane now that you are level 3 with all your abilities and still have all your hp.

The most important thing is to not lose all your HP on the first 2 waves. Just give up all 12 cs if you have to. The most important thing in a melee vs ranged lane is that the melee champion threatens a stronger all-in. However, if you're already at 50% hp, there is no all-in threat.

[Comment 4 | Score: 1]

A Health Potion costs 50 gold and restores 120 HP. It is usually worth it to sacrifice some minions in favor of not having to recall early.

[Comment 5 | Score: 1]

Depends on your champ but you have two usually, let them crash wave 2 and you will hit 3 sooner as their minions on the 3rd wave will die sooner. If they pull the wave/not push to not allow this to happen you have another option;

Take a short trade with your AOE spells on wave 1 to thin the wave. Establish a slow push but don't crash wave 2. Crash wave 3 and let wave 4 slow push back into you. When they must over extend to fix the wave this is your trade window, assuming the short trades wave 1 and 2 allowed them to be somewhat near lethal. This also opens them up to be ganked